Mint serves as the foundation for other libraries with higher levels of abstraction, but you won't use this in applications.

Finch

Finch[5] provides connection pooling on top of Mint.

You could use this in an application, but it's more common to reach for the next level of abstraction. Despite this, Finch is very popular even for people using it directly.

Tesla

Tesla[6] is an everything-included Elixir HTTP client. It's based on a Ruby library called Faraday. Tesla features an extensible plugin system as well as provides implementations for common tasks.

Some people prefer Tesla's module-based configuration and test-mocking features.

Req

Req[7] is an everything-included Elixir HTTP client built on top of Finch. It features an extensible plugin system as well as provided implementations for many common tasks.

There are quite a few options here, especially compared to Ruby. Let's dig into that.

Compared to Ruby

Ruby has a few commonly used HTTP clients: HTTParty, Faraday, and http.rb. These clients have been around for some time and appear to be largely adopted by the community. So, it comes as a bit of a surprise that there are so many options in Elixir.

There are two potential reasons for this. The first is that Elixir's concurrency model means that it's necessary to have a firm grip on the concurrency of your HTTP client. For example, if you accidentally issue 500 queries to the same URL at the same time, you may find that the other side crashes. So, you'll see libraries focused on pooling control in Elixir. Ruby is less concurrent, so you won't have this same problem and developers don't have to create solutions for it.

5. https://github.com/sneako/finch
6. https://github.com/elixir-tesla/tesla
7. https://github.com/wojtekmach/req